SOCE δ-Protocol v0.1

Graded divergence between independent coders

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1 · The δ scale (canonical)

The δ scale measures how far apart two signatures produced by independent analysts on the same case are. It is read from the components of $\Phi = \langle \sigma, V, E \rangle$ from the most superficial to the most structural. **Each grade contains the previous ones** (a δ_3 divergence is also δ_2 and δ_1): a legitimate ordinal order by inclusion, not a distance metric. There is no distance between grades; there is inclusion.

Grade	Name	What differs between the two signatures	Interpretation
δ_0	Convergent	Complete identical signature	No real dissent; spurious bifurcation
δ_1	Divergent in axis	A single value of V, or one σ state; links and family coincide	Interpretive noise — nuance, not phenomenon
δ_2	Divergent in link	The state of one or more links (e.g. → vs $\rightarrow^m$); dominant link and family coincide	Substantive but contained dissent
δ_3	Divergent in subgraph	Which link is dominant (⇒) — the causal skeleton reconfigures, within the same family	Two causal readings of the same type
δ_4	Divergent in family	Different topological families τ for the same case	Maximal structural separation

Why this and not a coefficient. A high inter-rater kappa over an ordinal object is illusory precision; convergence-of-signature plus versioned dissent by δ grades is *more* epistemically robust, because it makes auditable where judgment is genuinely ambiguous instead of hiding it behind a decimal.

2 · Arbitration mapping (canonical)

What governs the arbitration recommendation is the δ grade **sustained over new cases** — never its value on a single case. Stability is read qualitatively: does the grade get reabsorbed, or does it settle?

Sustained grade	Reading	Arbitration outcome
δ_0 – δ_1	Convergence or reabsorbable nuance	**Collapse to one rule** — one reading wins, the other is re-signed
δ_2 – δ_3	Substantive dissent within the same family; still ambiguous	**Keep in bifurcation**; watch whether it rises to δ_4 or reabsorbs to δ_1
δ_4 + divergent V→I cascade	Different families, divergent recursive closure, no reconciliation	**Promote to permanent theoretical distinction** — or recognise a new mechanism (E7) if the catalogue itself is insufficient

The decision is human and is itself stored as a meta-level validation act. The platform does not resolve epistemological dissent — it administers it, versions it, and preserves the trace of how the expert resolved it. Dissent opens two rule-branches without stopping the flow (git-branching of dissent); while arbitration waits, all accumulated signatures remain valid and consultable.

3 · Operating procedure for two coders — DRAFT, pending validation

> **Status.** §§1–2 above are canonical (extracted verbatim in substance from the project's canonical documents).

> This section assembles them into a step-by-step procedure two coders can execute. It is a **draft reconstruction**: it becomes canonical only on explicit approval by the project's canonical authority, and until then carries this banner.

1. **Independence.** Both coders produce Φ on the same case, each against the documented diagnosis, without communication during coding. Uncertainty flags (?) are recorded, not discussed.
2. **Disclosure.** Signatures are exchanged simultaneously, with their evidence citations and flags.
3. **Grading.** The pair reads the δ grade of the divergence directly from Φ, using the table in §1, at the *highest* applicable grade.
4. **Resolution by grade.**
   - **δ_0** — the case closes; one CVA records convergence.
   - **δ_1** — coders review the single diverging value against the anchor rubric and the Anchor Set precedent. If one reading lacks the required two independent sources, it yields. If both are sustained, the case carries the diverging value with a flag, and the divergence is logged.
   - **δ_2–δ_3** — no forced resolution. Both readings are recorded as branches; the case enters the bifurcation register. Subsequent cases are watched for reabsorption or escalation.
   - **δ_4** — the case escalates to the senior panel with both full signatures, evidence and flags. Outcomes: collapse / promote / recognise new mechanism (E7), each stored as a meta-level CVA; E7 triggers retrospective re-indexing.
5. **Record.** Every step leaves a trace: the two original signatures are never overwritten; resolution produces a *new* validated signature that cites both.

Open design item (inherited, not resolved here). The operationalisation of *"sustained"* — how many new cases, and what absence of reconciliation, counts as stabilisation of a δ grade — is deliberately left qualitative (a non-reconciliation window), pending definition. It must not be closed by a count threshold, which would reintroduce through the back door the τ_crit-type parameter the canon rejected.

4 · Machine coders

Two distinct AIs loading the same pack under the same canon are treated as two coders for exploratory purposes: their divergence is classified on the same δ scale and under the same jurisprudence as inter-human divergence. This does **not** alter the two-tier rule: a canonical signature still requires two trained *human* coders; machine–machine convergence is evidence about the interface, not a canonical diagnosis.